

## AI PERFORMANCE

We installed the Procyon Professional Benchmarking Suite and ran its AI Image Generation Benchmark, which employs the Stable Diffusion 1.5 (FP16) model. This benchmark generates 16 images in batches of four and returns a score based on the time taken to produce them. Being a GPU-intensive AI task, the Intel Lunar Lake chip leveraged its performance advantage, excelling in the AI image generation tests by a significant margin.

## BATTERY LIFE

Intel clearly had efficiency in mind, and it shows in our battery test results. We evaluated the Zenbook S 14's battery life using the Procyon Video Playback battery test, which continuously loops video playback until the battery drains to 5%. Impressively, the Zenbook S 14 lasted for 15 hours and 50 minutes. This surpasses our previous best-tested score of 13 hours and 15 minutes on the Qualcomm Snapdragon X-Elite-powered ASUS Vivobook S15. It also outperformed the AMD Ryzen AI 300-based ASUS Zenbook S16 by an even larger margin. All three laptops have similar battery capacities—the Qualcomm-powered ASUS Vivobook S15 and the Zenbook S 14 house 70Wh and 72Wh batteries respectively, while the AMD-powered Zenbook S16 has a slightly larger 78Wh battery.

Even during regular use—testing, benchmarking, and running multiple applications simultaneously—we didn't need to reach for a charger all day. This truly is an all-day battery life laptop without any application limitations, which speaks volumes about its power efficiency. Intel has delivered a competitive platform that goes head-to-head with Qualcomm's ARM-based Windows laptops, offering excellent battery life, especially when considering the app compatibility and performance optimizations inherent to the x86 platform compared to ARM-based Windows laptops in their current state.

## DISPLAY AND SOUND

The 14.0-inch, 3K (2880 x 1800) OLED

touch-enabled display on the ASUS Zenbook S 14 impressed us with its color accuracy and overall performance. Our display tests confirmed that the Zenbook S 14 delivers on its promise of a 100% DCI-P3 color gamut. ASUS claims a peak brightness of 400 nits; our measurements revealed a maximum brightness of 364 nits when testing the display across the center and corners. The color accuracy is also noteworthy, with an average Delta E (deviation) of 1.7, which is impressive. The display is bright, color-accurate, and sharp.

The speakers on this super thin and compact laptop sound surprisingly clear with good separation. Sure, they are not the loudest of all the laptops we've tested, but they are loud enough while being very crisp and wholesome. Even at max volumes, there is very little distortion and the sound doesn't just get loud, it also improves on the impact. For its size and profile, the ASUS Zenbook S 14 will surprise with its audio fidelity.

## DESIGN, BUILD QUALITY, AND THERMAL MANAGEMENT

The ASUS Zenbook S 14 essentially sports the same design we saw in the Zenbook S 16, featuring the unique "Cer-aluminum" finish that sets it apart. The Zenbook S 14 brings this cutting-edge design to a more compact form factor. The 14-inch variant retains the smooth matte ceramic-like finish on the lid, offering both ruggedness and elegance. Weighing just 1.2 kg with a slim profile of 1.1 cm, this laptop is exceptionally portable without compromising performance, as evidenced by our test results. The geometric grille design inside features 2,715 CNC-machined cooling vents, which are claimed to enhance thermal efficiency. ASUS's ambient cooling system, with dual fans and an ultra-slim vapor chamber, ensures quiet operation while maintaining an optimal 28-watt TDP without throttling. The all-metal body and premium materials make it stand out in the thin-and-light category, combining performance, design, portability, and efficiency in a masterfully crafted package. During our

testing, we never encountered excessive heat or thermal throttling issues. Given the slim and compact profile of the laptop, ASUS has done an excellent job with thermal management. Most of the heat was confined to the topmost part of the laptop—the area above the keyboard. The palm rest and keyboard remained comfortable even under heavy loads. The thermal performance of the ASUS Zenbook S 14 also highlights Intel's excellent power efficiency and thermal management with the Lunar Lake platform.

## VERDICT

The ASUS ZenBook S 14, powered by Intel's Lunar Lake platform, offers exceptional efficiency and performance in a thin-and-light laptop. Its standout feature is the nearly 16-hour battery life in video playback tests. While its mid-tier Intel Core Ultra 7 258V processor doesn't lead in multicore performance, it excels in single-core tasks and everyday computing. The integrated Intel Arc 140V GPU delivers a great show when it comes to gaming as well as GPU-centric AI and creative workloads. Weighing just 1.2 kg with a sleek design and Cer-aluminum finish, along with a vibrant 14-inch 3K OLED display, it balances performance, battery life, and design—making it an excellent choice for users seeking portability and efficiency.

—Soham Raninga

## SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Intel Core Ultra 7 258V Processor (Series 2), 8 cores (4P+4E) | RAM: 32GB LPDDR5X (Onboard) | Graphics: Intel Arc 140V (8-core GPU) | Display: 14.0-inch touch-enabled, 3K (2880 x 1800) OLED, 16:10 aspect ratio, 120Hz refresh rate, 400 nits claimed brightness (500 nits HDR peak), 100% DCI-P3 color gamut | Storage: 1TB PCIe 4.0 x4 NVMe M.2 SSD | Battery: 72Wh lithium-polymer battery | Weight: 1.20 kg | Dimensions: 31.15 x 21.39 x 1.19 ~ 1.29 cm | Connectivity: 1x USB 3.2 Gen 2 Type-A, 2x Thunderbolt 4 Type-C (supports display and power delivery), 1x HDMI 2.1, 1x 3.5mm Combo Audio Jack | Wireless Connectivity: Tri-band Wi-Fi 7 (802.11be) + Bluetooth 5.4

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